

Speaker 1 [00:00:04] All right, let's see. Okay, look, my thing is acting up a little bit. Alright. So, I'm just going to ask you a few questions here about demographics. First question. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:26] [20-25].

Speaker 1: [00:00:28] [20-25].

Speaker 1 [00:00:44] [20-25] years old. Uhm, how long have you been with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:51] [0-5] years and [5-10] months.

Speaker 1 [00:00:54] [0-5] years and [5-10] months, okay. Do you have any kids?

Speaker 2 [00:01:00] No.

Speaker 1 [00:01:01] Who lives in your household?

Speaker 2 [00:01:05] Me, my boyfriend, and then we live with four other roommates.

Speaker 1 [00:01:15] Good. What is your main source of income, or what is your current job?

Speaker 2 [00:01:22] Uhm, I currently work at [workplace].

Speaker 1 [00:01:27] [Workplace], Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:01:28] Yeah, right.

Speaker 1 [00:01:33] What do you do there, by any chance?

Speaker 2 [00:01:36] What's that?

Speaker 1 [00:01:37] What do you do there, by any chance?

Speaker 2 [00:01:39] Oh, I'm a [occupation].

Speaker 1 [00:01:43] Uhm, So for the rest of this interview, how would you like us to address your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:01:50] You could use a He/They pronoun.

Speaker 1 [00:01:53] He/They. Uhm. He/They pronouns. And then, if you want us to call them like boyfriend, partner?

Speaker 2 [00:02:00] Yeah. Boyfriend, partner is fine. If you want his name, his name is [partner's name]. [Spells partner's name].

[Portion Redacted]

Speaker 1 [00:03:49] Uhm, Alright. How would you compare the quality of your relationship compared to that of your friend's relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:04:03] Uhm, I know a lot of my friends have difficulty in communicating with their partners. And I'd like to say that my communication skills with my partner are way above average. Uhm, every Sunday, we have these talks called toe talks. Uhm, we sit down on the floor, our toes are touching. So, we're still away from each other, but still have this physical touch and we just communicate any problems we have or, you know, doesn't really have to be a problem, just like what you're up to, how you feel. Uhm, and typically, like, we don't really wait for these talks to communicate with each other. Like, we're always open, but these talks just solidify something we have in place. Like, oh yeah, we're going to talk this week, uhm, I just want to like mention that I'm stressed this week, and he asks like how he can help, and it's just vice versa. Uhm, it's just a way to ground ourselves and knowing what we're up to and each other's lives since we're so busy.

Speaker 1 [00:05:08] Okay, alright. Sounds good. Uhm, okay. For the next question, which still pertains to relationship quality. How many partners did you have prior? Uhm, how many partners did you have in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:05:21] Uhm, zero. It was not necessarily partners, but it was just people I would date but nothing was ever official. So, I guess it's zero.

Speaker 1 [00:05:36] Uhm, okay. So, if you compared your dates with the dates you have with your boyfriend now, how would you compare the quality of it?

Speaker 2 [00:05:46] Uhm, the dates with my boyfriend now are higher in quality. We do things that, you know, like real couples do. I guess prior to this, me in the past dates would just go get Boba, something super simple. Uhm, now, we go to like museums, we go on day trips, we go on actual trips. Uhm, so yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:06:24] Okay, so this one. Uhm. For you, what makes a relationship high or low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:06:33] Uhm, I think what makes our relationship high quality is that our families get along with each other. Uhm, our parents have the same political beliefs, they have, they were raised pretty much in the same generation. Uhm, and they have like similar music tastes, similar interests, and I think that's really important in, I guess like a romantic relationship because any sort of conflict can be really rough. Uhm, and that's also a problem that I've seen with my friends and their partners and their partner's families that they don't get along, and it's like really tough, especially during big gatherings like Thanksgiving and Christmas, but it's the opposite for me like everyone gets along.

Speaker 1 [00:07:24] Okay. So, what would make the relationship low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:07:32] Uhm, I guess making a relationship, or a relationship that would be low quality is, uhm, lack of communication. Uhm, I guess a lot of arguments without resolution. Uhm, not that arguments is a bad thing, but just constant conflict and just lack of communication.

Speaker 1 [00:08:00] Okay. Thank you. Thank you. Uhm, how about this? What is the most important thing in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:08:13] Uhm, I guess it's going to tie back to what I said before, just communication. I think it's important for not just romantic relationships, but all relationships.

Speaker 1 [00:08:26] It's good. Uhm. So, this question has more to do with love. Uhm. For you, what is love?

Speaker 2 [00:08:40] What is love? Love is knowing that they have your back and I have theirs. Uhm. You know, if I'm, like, stuck in the middle of the road at 3 a.m., I can always rely on my partner. Uhm, he is just always there for me, and yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:09:05] Okay. How important is love?

Speaker 2 [00:09:11] I think love is important because it makes people feel good. And I know that some people have like a very negative view of love, but love can be between you and your dog, you and your brother. Uhm. Not necessarily like romantic love, but I think love is very, very important.

Speaker 1 [00:09:42] How do you know if your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:09:46] I know my partner loves me because I think we've come a long way. We've stuck with each other at our lows and highs, and now we currently live together, and, you know, he'll make me coffee in the morning, he'll help me make dinner at night, and that's how I know he loves me.

Speaker 1 [00:10:09] Yeah. Uhm, alright. So, the next few questions. What would you say are the challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:10:21] Challenges. Uhm, I think one of them is definitely our schedule. Uhm. I. We're not like, busy, like too busy for each other, but, you know, work and then me being in grad school does conflict with our time and I feel like we could get way more quality time besides just the weekends. But for now, it's just like we only have pretty much just one full day to ourselves, uhm, which is Saturday. But that's one of the main issues, and I guess another one is living with roommates. Uhm. I guess it's an issue because I guess we like our privacy. I mean, we're fortunate that the way our house is set up, we get the entire first floor to ourselves, but I guess I value privacy a lot. So, that is another struggle. But other than that, I think everything is pretty smooth.

Speaker 1 [00:11:25] Alright. Alright. Sounds good. Uhm, do you and your partner fight?

Speaker 2 [00:11:32] Uhm, no. It's more like disagreements, but no.

Speaker 1 [00:11:47] Uhm, okay. So, aside from. Yeah, I know you guys don't fight, but if you guys would, what other ways would you do to maintain that? What do you do to maintain the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:12:04] Uhm, can you repeat the question?

Speaker 1 [00:12:06] What are other ways that you would do to maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:12:11] Other ways to maintain our relationship. Uhm, I think it's important to spend that quality time together since we are so busy. Uhm. I think it's important that we, you know, still go on dates, even though we live with each other, and see each other every day. But it's not like we're not going to date every day, we're not going to movies every day, which is okay, and I think it helps me value our quality time together and value it a lot more. Uhm. So, what we do is, you know, we'll plan something once a month, something really big, like go to museum, go out to dinner, and that's really what helps us stay strong.

Speaker 1 [00:12:54] Okay. Uhm. Would you say that your relationship is good for you? Why?

Speaker 2 [00:13:05] Yes, because I think we're yin and yang. Uhm. He's very outgoing. I'm more on the reserve side and I think it goes really well. I think it helped me become more outgoing being around him, and I think it helps me also center myself with people, like with great people, because prior to meeting him, I didn't have the best friends, I didn't have the best circle of friends. Uhm. And, being around him is just helped me stay positive and be surrounded by better people.

Speaker 1 [00:13:45] Okay, yeah. So, could you. Could you just provide a specific example of when he like helped you become more outgoing?

Speaker 2 [00:13:54] Yeah. So, during our undergrad years, he would constantly throw, like, parties every weekend and I wasn't really used to that. I wasn't really used to, you know, socializing in that type of setting, and he would always introduce me to people that are over, and I think that really helped me start initiating, initiating conversations with people because I was never like that. I was very shy when I first met him, and reserved, and yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:14:34] Okay. So, the next question. Uhm. Will you, did the relationship change you? If so, in what way?

Speaker 2 [00:14:42] Uhm, I'd like to say yes. And, I think it's, our relationship has made me have a higher level of self-esteem. I think it's made me a lot more confident, a lot like seeing someone love me for the way I am makes me want to express myself more. The way I dress, the way I, I guess, yeah, express myself through Social media, outside of social media. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:15:17] Uhm. Did your partner change during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:15:23] Uhm. I'd like to say yes. I think, his style has definitely changed. Not because I, like said anything about it, but I think it's changed a lot. I think he's a lot more comfortable in the way he is. I can see that he enjoys the way he styles himself. Uhm, yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:15:51] Uhm. So, we'll go back to you. Actually, no, that should be fine. But is the person who you were before the same as where you are now?

Speaker 2 [00:16:05] Uhm, no. Did you want me to provide an example?

Speaker 1 [00:16:10] Uhm, sure.

Speaker 2 [00:16:12] Uhm. I guess before meeting him I was careless. I didn't really care much about myself, let alone other people. Uhm. I think being with him made me more aware of my emotional surroundings and it made me more aware of, or just made me put myself in other shoes, allowed me to see different perspectives. So, I guess before I was a lot more cold, reserved, and shy, and now I'm the complete opposite.

Speaker 1 [00:16:50] What about your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:16:52] Uhm, I'd like to say he is about the same. He doesn't have any changes in personality. Uhm. I know that his interests have changed, he's been going to like a lot more social events, like concerts, bars, which is nice because I also enjoy going to concerts. But I think he's changed, but not in the same way I changed.

Speaker 1 [00:17:23] Alright. So, this is my next question for you. Do you feel safe in your relationship and why do you say it so?

Speaker 2 [00:17:33] Yes, I do. I feel safe because there's trust. Uhm. We trust each other, and there's nothing that he's done that's made me lose that trust, and I'd like to say vice versa. There's nothing I've done to make him lose his trust. So, yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:17:53] Uhm, could you provide an example of when this trust is kept?

Speaker 2 [00:17:59] I know a lot of my friends have difficulty, uhm, when their partner like goes on a trip, to [Location], [Location]. I know they're always like, oh, my gosh, like, what if they cheat on me? But I know if he were to go on a trip like that, I know he wouldn't partake in that. And, I know also a lot of my friends have like locations sharing with their partners, we don't, we trust each other in that way.

Speaker 1 [00:18:36] So for the next question, I want to show you a Likert scale. Let me just pull it up.

Speaker 2 [00:18:47] Okay

Speaker 1 [00:18:49] Likert scale

Speaker 1 [00:19:11] So, if you can see my screen here, you can kind of see like there's a PowerPoint going on.

Speaker 2 [00:19:17] I think it's still. Is it? There you go.

Speaker 1 [00:19:20] Is it?

Speaker 2 [00:19:22] Yeah, I'm good. I can see that.

Speaker 1 [00:19:24] Yeah. So, I just need you to answer. Like, answer the question here on the Likert scale. It's just basically on a scale of 1 to 9. One being, it's not true at all, not at all true to nine being completely true. Uhm. The statement my partner usually really listens to me. What would your answer, uhm, be for that?

Speaker 2 [00:19:50] Uhm I'd say eight.

Speaker 1 [00:19:52] Eight. Okay. So, for eight. What, could you like give me a reason why. Why did you answer eight for this question?

Speaker 2 [00:20:08] Yeah. So, I feel like if something is bugging me or bothering me and I let him know, like, hey, you know, this thing is really bugging me. Uhm. We talk it out, he listens, and he doesn't make that mistake again. And, I wouldn't really choose nine because, though it's true, he usually does listen to me but sometimes he gets distracted with his book, his phone, and I'll like, say something and, you know, he just won't respond, but it's not really a big problem.

Speaker 1 [00:20:45] Okay. Right. So, I have another question. Were you? See. Uhm. Okay for this question, the Likert scale still applies. One is not true. Nine is completely true. Uhm. On a scale of 1 to 9, the statement, my partner is usually responsive to my needs, where would you rank your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:21:15] Uhm, I'd say nine.

Speaker 1 [00:21:18] Okay. Why did you choose nine? Can you provide some examples?

Speaker 2 [00:21:23] Yeah, of course. So, I guess an example would be, uhm, let's say I'm running low on my medication. I would go ahead and give him a call, be like, hey, do you think you can pick this up at this pharmacy? I'll give you my information. And not only with names like let's say I'm running low on, I don't know, shampoo, conditioner, I can always count on him to help me get that for me when I don't have, or like when I'm not able to.

Speaker 1 [00:22:00] Uhm, why not eight?

Speaker 2 [00:22:05] Uhm. I guess not eight, because there hasn't ever really been a moment where I asked him to help me with something, and he would say no, because I guess we're pretty independent and it's not like I constantly need something from him. All I'm really asking for is, I guess, to just respect each other. So, yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:22:36] Okay, yeah. So, for our next question. Uhm. I hope you don't mind if I ask. Uhm. Since you mentioned earlier, I do hope you don't mind if I ask, and feel free to say this if this is too sensitive for you to share, but I also wanted to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple.

Speaker 2 [00:23:04] Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:23:05] So, my question for this is these days how often do you guys have sex?

Speaker 2 [00:23:09] Uhm. I want to say, every other week. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:23:18] Okay. So, okay. Give me a moment... (inaudible)

Speaker 2 [00:23:28] Yeah. Yeah, of course.

Speaker 1 [00:23:42] Sorry about that. Uhm, alright. So, for my next question, how satisfied are you with your sex life and why do you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:23:53] Uhm. I guess I'm really satisfied because you know, again, like we are so busy, and sometimes, like, we just don't have time like we did before when we were in undergrad. Uhm, but I think I'm pretty satisfied because, you know, we're still engaging in those activities, but it's not like taking too much time, not that it does in general, but, you know, we do other things that are pretty intimate, like go on a picnic, watch a movie together. So, I think it's. Yeah, I think it's good.

Speaker 1 [00:24:37] Okay. Uhm. Thank you for that. So, I just have a last few more, last few more questions for you and I'm going to show you the Likert scale again. I may show you 2 more, or 3 more. Alright. So with this Likert scale, this basically just asked you about your global satisfaction, by how satisfied you are in the relationship. So basically, on a scale of like completely, completely dissatisfied to completely satisfied, how satisfied are you with your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:25:16] Uhm, I am completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:25:23] Right. So, completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:25:40] Alright, So, completely satisfied. What if you were to rate down a scale of zero to ten? Zero meaning you are not at all satisfied and ten meaning you are completely satisfied. Where would you rank your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:25:58] So, I would rank it as ten.

Speaker 1 [00:26:03] Uhm, can you explain why it is ten?

Speaker 2 [00:26:05] Yeah, of course. So, I rated this as ten or I rated our relationship as ten because I didn't have any expectations before this relationship. I have never been any, in any other relationships. But I know coming from an outside perspective, a lot of my friends and family say that I think we know what we're doing and we are in a solid relationship, and it seems like we have no problems on the outside, that's not true. Uhm. But to everyone, they're saying it's like an ideal relationship, and think I'm pretty satisfied like I can feel like myself around him, and I'd like to say he feels the same with me.

Speaker 1 [00:27:04] Uhm, can you. So, can you tell me why you didn't rate them a nine?

Speaker 2 [00:27:10] Yeah, I guess I didn't rate this relationship a nine because that would mean that I am not completely satisfied, and I know not every relationship is perfect, but I think it's perfect for me, and I think it's probably like the best connection I have in my life currently.

Speaker 1 [00:27:53] Okay. Uhm. So, we are also wrapping up. I would just like to summarize what we've conversed in the past, you know like 30-ish minutes or so, the last 30 minutes. So, yeah, I know that you're [20-25] years old. You've been with [partner's name], your partner, for [0-5] years and [5-10] months, no kids. There's six people in the house that includes you and your boyfriend. You're a [occupation] at [workplace]. Your boyfriend is [partner's name], he has he/they pronouns.

Speaker 2 [00:28:26] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:28:26] [Portion Redacted]. So, that your relationship probably has better communication than your friends. Uhm, this is your like first official partner, apart from like

the other dates here and there. The quality of relationships involves families getting along, same political beliefs, same music and generation, and the ability to like solve for conflicts. Or relationship with the lack of communication, lots of arguments, and no resolution, communication is important. Feel free to stop me though, if I'd say something inaccurate.

Speaker 2 [00:29:36] Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:29:37] Uhm, okay, we talked about love and love. Love is the idea that he has your back and you have is. Uhm. How important is love? Love is very important, even though some people, you know, they do have a negative perception of it. You guys came a long way. Uhm. You said your biggest, you guys don't fight but your biggest issues just involve privacy and like time.

Speaker 2 [00:29:53] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:22:55] Uhm, you guys don't fight. All the time together, that's how your, that's kind of your resolution response for the disagreements you guys have. Uhm, he kind of helps you become more going, right?

Speaker 2 [00:30:09] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:30:10] And, so it's kind of like, yeah, It's somewhat of a yin and yang or a general sense, yeah. He helps you with self-esteem and confidence. His style has changed, but he didn't really change in the way you did.

Speaker 2 [00:30:24] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:30:26] So. So, would that be something like, something like you changed personalities, but when it came to like, deep down, he didn't really change that much?

Speaker 2 [00:30:34] No, he's remained about the same.

Speaker 1 [00:30:38] Uhm. You feel safe, and you know that some of your friends they're worried that their partner cheats in the relationship, but you know that you guys won't do that. In the scales and that your scales are tilted towards high satisfaction. Uhm. As for sex, it's every other week, and you're really satisfied, right? So that's the gist of the summary. Uhm. Let's see. Is there anything else that you wanted to ask?

Speaker 2 [00:31:07] Uhm, I think I'm good for now.

Speaker 1 [00:31:11] Alright. Uhm. So, thank you so much. Now, before we end, I want to talk to you about how we will handle the data. Uhm. As a research project, we want to be as ethically transparent as possible, and so I wanted to know which data-sharing option you might be most affordable with. Option one is that your transcript portions can be shared, none of which can be identified to you, so the de-identified transcript can also be read by the other researchers. Uhm. If you want option two. If you were bolder, another option is that the whole transcript can be shared, removed of sensitive and overly identifying details, so it will be anonymized. Although in this option, there is a very minimal chance that someone who knows you well can piece together the details in the transcript and narrow it down among their colleagues and believe it is, that among their colleagues who they believe it is. Although again, none of this, no, none of your sensitive information will be shared. Uhm. So, of the two options, which are you more comfortable with?

Speaker 2 [00:32:21] The first one.

Speaker 1 [00:32:23] Is there anything that you want to like, uhm, that you wanted to, like, de-identify? Like is there any?

Speaker 2 [00:32:33] Uhm. No, I'm okay with all of it.

Speaker 1 [00:32:34] Okay. Alright. That's good. Okay. Thank you so much again for participating in the study. I would like to know. I would like you to know, I know I said this at the start, but I would like you to know that this is also being done in the Philippines, Brazil, Turkey, and France, not just the US. For the study to be successful, there is also one more thing that we would like to ask, if that's fine by you. If that's okay for you. Can you recommend two close people in your life as a nominator. We would ask them for additional couple, couples that they might be that might be interested in this study, but will be asking them for couples that they don't, that you don't know or interact with. Uhm. This way we can get stay as diverse as we can get. Is that okay for you?

Speaker 2 [00:33:22] Uhm, yes. I just can't think of anyone at the top of my head right now, though.

Speaker 1 [00:33:27] Okay, yeah. Alright, yeah. So, that's fine. Thank you. We will be contacting them today or tomorrow or whenever it comes up. Uhm, yeah. So that being said, that's pretty much the end of the interview. Thank you so much for taking like 35 minutes of your time, uhm, for the interview. If you do know people who you think would be part of this study or you just suspect that they are, they might be good for the study, so let me know. Other than that, I guess you have a nice day.

Speaker 2 [00:34:03] Thank you so much, bye.

Speaker 1 [00:34:05] Thank you, bye.